



Land & Traffic Committee Meeting January 22nd 2025

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=E0KY49Gy89M
Publication Date	2025-01-23T12:56:06Z
Target Category	muncie_city

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

Municipal Meeting Summary Report

1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

- **Session Type & Topic:** Land Traffic Committee meeting and discussion on four proposed annexation ordinances [00:00:28](#).
- **Summary of Discussion:** The committee opened discussions regarding four proposed territory annexations into the city of Muncie, Indiana, incorporating public testimony, administrative responses, and specific neighborhood feedback regarding infrastructure, police/fire services, and fiscal impacts.

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Land Traffic Committee meeting called to order by the presiding officer [00:00:28](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - Members Present: Ms. Gulan, Ms. Kay, Mr. McIntosh.
 - Absent: Not specified.
 - Presiding Officer: Mr. McIntosh (Committee Chair / Lead facilitator).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Recitation of the Pledge of Allegiance followed by an opening invocation 00:00:31.
- **Approval of Minutes:** Not mentioned in the transcript.

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- 00:01:44 **Ordinance 29-24: Portions of Farmington Neighborhood Annexation Ordinance**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Introduced by the Administration / City Representatives.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion focused heavily on resident pushback, tax caps, street repairs, and response times. City Attorney Max Adams stated that property tax caps would remain under 1%, municipal water and sanitary services would not change, and assessed values are determined independently at the county level. The city engineer's report estimated \$150,000 for immediate street repairs in Farmington and \$20,530 annually for routine maintenance.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - *John Fallon* (00:02:01) representing the Farmington Neighborhood Association ad hoc committee, registered formal objections, noting that 40 out of 59 affected property owners (exceeding the 65% statutory threshold) opposed the annexation. He raised concerns regarding county-city road paving plans, police/fire response times, lack of direct city notification to certain residents, and unreturned information requests sent to the city street department.
 - *Kirsten Smith* (00:09:00 / 00:43:41) questioned the financial benefit to residents, noting current satisfaction with county services and expressing concern that tax revenues would simply shift to the city.
 - *David Hankle* (00:36:05) raised concerns over construction traffic impacts and potential special property assessments or bond fees.
 - *Gary Wangler* (00:37:56), Farmington Homeowners Association President, discussed potential connector road plans, heavy construction traffic, and long-term property tax cap stability risks.
 - *Chief Ernest Burford* (00:50:35) and *Union President/Battalion Chief Jason Chaen* (01:19:33) clarified that Muncie Fire Department already provides coverage via township agreements, but annexation revenue could assist in supporting enhanced EMS staffing (such as Medic 7).
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Held for discussion/committee review (eligible for City Council vote in March, entering a 90-day remonstrance period post-adoption).
- 00:08:09 **Ordinance 31-24: City-Owned Parcel Near Farmington Neighborhood Annexation**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** The Mayor / Administration.
- **Deliberation Summary:** The Mayor explained that 12 acres were donated by Ball State University with the explicit stipulation that a housing subdivision be developed. The land sits in the county, bounded by city limits to the east and south. The intent is to partner with homebuilders to provide high-end housing options for community recruitment.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** Addressed via ongoing discussions during the Farmington segment regarding traffic, construction, and development plans.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Held for committee review/discussion.
- **00:03:19 Ordinance 30-24: Portions of Heron Point Neighborhood Annexation Ordinance**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** The Administration / City Representatives.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** City officials noted that Heron Point generates approximately \$300,000 in total property taxes, with the city expecting to net roughly \$149,000 post-annexation by reallocating shares from county and local overlapping taxing districts. School districts remain unaffected by municipal annexations under state law.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:**
 - *Brian Marsh (00:33:34)*, Heron Point Neighborhood Association President, noted that residents had not conducted a formal neighborhood vote, cited life events delaying his direct engagement, and expressed community concerns regarding fire protection changes, street maintenance, and potential impacts on Wes-Del Community Schools.
 - *Isabelle Sour (01:31:29)* asked for clarification on tax revenue distribution and where unallocated shares flow.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Held for committee review/discussion.
- **01:25:37 Ordinance 32-24: Westminster Village Annexation Ordinance**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** The Administration / City Representatives.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Westminster Village's board voted unanimously for a super-voluntary annexation. Because it operates as a non-profit entity, direct property tax yields are minimal (less than \$1,000), but emergency medical services (EMS) billing generated by runs to the facility are projected to provide substantial revenue to Fire Department Fund 104.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** Committee members questioned the financial rationale of annexing tax-exempt non-profit property versus securing a direct services contract. Fire officials emphasized that annexation guarantees permanent service coverage compared to volatile private contracts.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Held for committee review/discussion.

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

(General citizen remarks recorded throughout and near the conclusion of the session) -

01:42:54 Brandon Garrett (Council Member / Resident): Spoke during open dialogue thanking residents for attending, encouraging ongoing communication with council members through March 3rd, and praising local police and fire services. - **01:44:19 Mr. McIntosh** (Committee Chair): Offered closing remarks reflecting on historical development patterns, expressing a personal preference for prioritizing municipal investments and revitalization on Muncie's East side.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Council members requested that administrative staff and the Mayor provide the detailed fiscal plan formulas, engineer reports, and calculation breakdowns to all nine council members prior to the full council session.
- **Adjournment:** The committee work session concluded following final comments from the chair (**01:45:40**).

Muncie Policy Memo Civic Monitoring Automated Pipeline. Report generated on 2026-09-30 02:19:02 using model gemini-3.5-flash-lite.